BIA550: Business Intelligence Tools

POST UNIVERSITY - WATERBURY CAMPUS
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Post UNIVERSITY®
THE MALCOLM BALDRIGE SCHOOL OF BUSINESS®

Course Information

BIA550: Business Intelligence Tools
Credits: 3 Semester Hours

Course Description

This course comprehensively introduces business intelligence (BI) concepts, tools, and applications. Students will learn how to leverage BI technologies to support data-driven decision-making in organizations. The course will provide hands-on experience with industry-standard BI tools such as Tableau, Power BI, or MicroStrategy. Through lectures, case studies, and practical exercises, students will develop the skills to gather requirements, design BI solutions, and deliver actionable insights to support business objectives. By the end of the course, students will be able to effectively utilize BI tools to analyze complex datasets and communicate data-driven recommendations as proposed in our chat.

Course Materials

Required:

- Coronel, C., & Morris, S. (2023). *Database Systems: Design, Implementation, & Management* (14th Edition). Cengage Learning.

BIA Program Outcomes

Students in the BIA Program will:

1. Assess the organization's business for business intelligence and analytics systems.
2. Formulate business intelligence and analytics systems and process requirements.
3. Organize business intelligence and analytics team and responsibility requirements.
4. Correlate business and processes related to business intelligence and analytics applications

Course Outcomes

Students participating in this course will:

1. Evaluate various business intelligence tools.
2. Evaluate database systems design, implementation, and management.
3. Construct successful databases.
4. Design databases that align with the larger strategic goals and environment.
5. Apply business-making decisions based on database design.

Course Procedures

This course is organized into a series of weekly lessons (Units) composed of readings, discussions among and between the students and instructor, and “homework” assignments, which build upon the readings and discussion. Each Unit has a closing date of Sunday at 11:59 p.m. unless otherwise stated). *You must have participated in the discussion and handed in the assignment by the end of the Unit date.*
It is expected that the materials provided in the units will be reviewed as well as any additional materials, notes or presentations by the instructor.

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The course is laid out with the following process in mind:

1. Review the Readings assigned for a topic
2. Participate in the Discussion – ask questions
3. Complete the Homework Assignment – per the syllabus
4. Set aside time each week for the Projects and review them quickly so you do not wait until the last moment.
5. Each week's assignment builds toward the final project, where you will apply the course concepts and the program concepts of innovation and practical application of concepts.

Grading

Grades for this course will be based upon

- Discussions - 20%
- Assignments - 40%
- Final Project - 40%

Discussion Board Participation and Grading

Success in the MBA Program depends in very large part on the student's participation in the class discussions (Discussion Board). The Student is accountable for understanding and complying with the general standards for participation in Class Discussions, the requirements in the MBA Discussion Board Rubric, and the individual instructor's guidelines.

*See the item in **Course Information** titled **Discussion Board Criteria and Grading Rubric** for more specific expectations of quality participation and the Grading Rubric.*

Assignment Grading

Each assignment has an assignment number and due date. Assignments are due on the Sunday of the week they are assigned by midnight EST unless otherwise noted. Assignments are to be submitted on time and throughout the course.

See the assignment area under each unit for assignment criteria and grading rubric for more specific expectations.

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Course Outline

Unit	Topic	Assignment
1	Unit 1: Real-Life Impact of BI	• Unit 1 Discussion Board: Real-Life Impact of BI • Unit 1 Assignment: Understanding and Comparing BI Tools • Unit 1 Assignment: Access Lucid and Understanding Relational Diagrams
2	Unit 2: Data Warehousing Essentials	• Unit 2 Discussion Board: Unraveling Organizational Mysteries - Case Study Analysis • Unit 2 Assignment: Designing a Data Warehouse
3	Unit 3: SQL Skills for BI	• Unit 3 Discussion Board: SQL Skills for BI • Unit 3 Assignment: Mastering SQL Queries • Start Work on Final Group Project in Unit 7
4	Unit 4: Visualizing Data for Impact	• Unit 4 Discussion Board: Visualizing Data for Impact • Unit 4 Assignment: Data Visualization Principles and Practice • Continue Work on Final Group Project in Unit 7
5	Unit 5: Interactive and User-Friendly Dashboards	• Unit 5 Discussion Board: Interactive and User-Friendly Dashboards • Unit 5 Assignment: Designing User-Friendly Dashboards • Continue Work on Final Group Project in Unit 7
6	Unit 6: Leveraging Predictive Analytics	• Unit 6 Discussion Board: Leveraging Predictive Analytics • Unit 6 Assignment: Exploring Predictive Analytics in BI • Continue Work on Final Group Project in Unit 7
7	Unit 7: Success and Challenges in BI Projects	• Unit 7 Discussion Board: Success and Challenges in BI Projects • Unit 7 Assignment: Implementing a Comprehensive BI Solution
8	Unit 8: Ethical and Future Considerations in BI	• Unit 8 Discussion Boards • Unit 8 Assignment: Reflecting on BI Learnings and Future Trends

Post University Credit Hour Expectations

Post University takes the integrity of our coursework very seriously. A credit hour is an academic unit earned for engaged academic time, including classroom or online instruction and outside study. This expectation varies based on the type of class in which you are enrolled.

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Main Campus Courses
For a 3-credit semester course, you are expected to engage in three hours of in-class learning and six hours of outside study for a total of nine hours of engaged academic time per week for 15 weeks.

Accelerated Online or Hybrid Site Courses
For an accelerated 8-week, 3-credit hybrid site or online course, you are expected to engage in 17 hours of engaged academic time per week; for a hybrid site course, 3 hours will be on site.

Blended Courses
Blended courses vary in the balance of classroom and online instruction. For a 3-credit blended course, students are expected to complete a total of 135 hours of engaged academic time, whether it is a semester-long or accelerated format.

What is 'engaged academic time'?
This is when you are engaging in academic learning activities related to a course. These activities include both in-class, out-of-class, and online activities such as readings, lectures, group work, videos, presentations, webinars, research, writing, surveys, discussions, practice exercises, web development, creating, producing, studying, and any other learning experiences that contribute to the achievement of course outcomes.

Your responsibility as a student at Post University is to fulfill these academic expectations in the time you devote to this class.

To ensure that we continue to meet our academic standards and your learning expectations, we routinely assess our programs, courses, and instructors. Completion of the end-of-course Student Survey is a required component of this course.

For the full Academic Credit Hour Policy, please refer to the Post University Catalog and/or the Post University website.

University Policies and Procedures*

Following are the policies and procedures for graduate courses at Post University. These are too considered part of the course syllabus for the course for which I am the instructor. Please read this document carefully. If you have any questions about the contents of this document, please ask.

Email
When using email correspondence, please use the class identifier in the Subject area. For example: BUS510 and sign your message with your name so the instructor knows who it is from.

Scheduled Absences
If you will miss class for religious reasons, work obligations, military duty, or have other absences you are aware of, please inform the instructor in writing via email at least two weeks prior to the date you will be absent from class.

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Unearned F Policy
Post University recognizes that student participation in courses is essential to student success. Course participation is assessed by faculty at the time that final course grades are determined. Faculty members will assign an unearned F grade to a student who does not complete graded academic activity after the midpoint of a course. When a student receives an unearned F grade, the faculty member will determine the date the student submitted his or her last graded academic activity. This will be considered the student's withdrawal date from the course.

As a result of receiving an unearned F, a student may be administratively withdrawn. The University may be required to calculate how much financial aid the student has earned for the term. This calculation may result in the return of unearned financial aid to the U.S. Department of Education or other third parties. The student may be obligated to pay for charges originally paid by the unearned financial aid and/or return any excess funds paid to the student. Receiving an unearned F may also impair future course registrations and financial aid availability. Unearned F grades also count as failing grades in the student's GPA and pace of completion. Please see the policies on Administrative Withdrawal and Satisfactory Academic Progress.

Academic Dishonesty
Academic dishonesty includes but is not limited to, willful or inadvertent plagiarism, cheating, unauthorized collaboration, unauthorized use of digital materials, the introduction of viruses, willful interruption of systems, and may also include unintentional complicity in other's academic dishonesty.

Professional Conduct and Civility
Post University's graduate programs assume that all students attend for a serious purpose. Students are expected to conduct themselves as responsible individuals with high standards of academic integrity. The University will not condone academic dishonesty in any form nor tolerate violations of professional ethics within the academic community. Post University reserves the right to dismiss a student from the graduate school for any behavior deemed to be unprofessional or unethical.

Note: All and full University policies can be found in the University Catalog, Graduate Studies Handbook, University Policies link in your course, and/or Website.

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